

Mata o Muna 8 / Chapter 8

Faifaiga o te Fenua Katoa / Community-wide Customs and Traditions

Tuvalu	English
I kautama katoa kolā e uke ni ola i Nanumea, a 'tou tupuga ni fatuaki he vaega olaga telā e tatau o fakamautakitaki kae ke tauga malie ki te maumea me malamalahia o te 'tou motu mō mea e ola i ona tafa ia me i luga. Ko te tuahivi (fatu matakiokioga) o te 'tou olaga māhani ko te loto gātahi o tino katoa i ai. A te makeke o manatu ki te tufatufaga ke pagatahi i te lelei o mea a te fenua e heke tā kī mai manatu mapu taki tahi ake kolā ni fakafua mai i fakatauga mō fenua papālagi. E tonu he takutinogaga a tātou ko te aogā o te kau fakatahi hē puiga mō tātou tama a Nanumea o fakamau kae fakamaumea ake a mafuliga ni lavea i loto i te vahia tenei e 150 tauhaga. E 'tou iloa mahalafia ia tātou ni tupu mai ia Tefolaha, kae e tā taviligina hoki e tātou ia tātou ko "gā tama a Tefolaha." A te hokoga o Tefolaha ki fakatakitakiga faka 'tou fenua mō fakapotopotoga faka politiki koa oti ni talatalagina i Mata o Muna muamua ake. Nei, ke fuliake 'tou pulaga ki faiga ake faka tātou kolā e mafai o akutu e ia tātou mō fakamāfua a lukuga a Nanumea.	Over the many generations they lived in Nanumea, our ancestors developed a way of life that is sustainable and appropriate to the resources and constraints of our atoll's environment. One of the cornerstones of our traditional way of life is the unity (loto gātahi) of the community. This strong commitment to the shared well-being of the fenua as a whole is utterly different from the individualistic orientation that dominates western societies. Probably it has been our commitment to this value of unity that has allowed Nanumea to endure, and even to prosper, from the changes of the last 150 years. We think of ourselves as all sharing descent from Tefolaha and often say that we are all "children of Tefolaha." Tefolaha's connection to our island's traditional leadership and political organization have been discussed in previous chapters. Here we turn our attention to other customs and traditions that bind us together as the Nanumean community.
Tufa mō te Nifo A te tāua o te pāgatahi he fakavae makeke e tahi o faifaiga o lukuga a Nanumea. E hē he mea fakapoī ki fakanohoga mō auala tonu i te tufaga ke 'pau a kainaga/vaega o tino katoa o te fakapotopotoga. E lua a putukau e a lātou a haga ki te vaevaega o mea maua a te fenua, pelā mō ika mō mea ake hoki e aumai mai mā te fenua e auala i he alofa ofo tuā mō mea ake. Kau o te Nifo: Ko lātou kolā e a lātou te haga ki te helehelega o ika, pelā mō fonu, mō ika 'lahi (takuo, pāla) e katikati e lātou konei. Oti ni katikati a ika katoa, koa tuku i ai ki te kau o te tufa. Kau o te Tufa: Ko lātou kolā e a lātou te haga ki te tufaga o meakai faka te fenua, i taimi o 'kaiga kolā e fai i te āhiga, mō mea ake hoki a te fenua e 'tau o tufa.	Distribution and Dividing Up The value of equality is one of the foundation stones of traditional Nanumean society. Thus, it is not surprising that we had an institutionalized way to be sure that communal resources were evenly divided among community members. Two groups had responsibilities (pologa) that were complementary in regard to any resources, including fish, that were presented to the community as a whole. The Dividers (Kau o te Nifo): They have the responsibility of cutting up fish, turtles, and large ocean fish such as takuo and pāla. Once these have been cut up, they are given to the Distributors. The Distributors (Kau o te Tufa): They have the responsibility for distributing food and any other things which the island needs to share out, in accord with customary rules, during island feasts.

Muna a tino, kae fai he tino e hē ona a te pologa kae fia māhani o fano o tufa, e mafai o oko ki he tulaga fai valevale a te tufaga o meakai, pelā mō ni tino koa hē maua ni vaega o lātou. E pelā hoki mō te kau o te nifo, e katikati faka'tau ailoa e lātou a ika ke tofu katoa ailoa a tino takitokotahi mō tona tufaga.

I pō mua, ni heke ailoa a galuega a lāua konei, te tufa mō te nifo. Kae i pō nei, pelā ailoa me koa fai fakatahi a lā galuega.

Faifaiga mō Fonu

A te fonu he ika e hili i te fia kakai ki ai a te taulahiga o tino, kae e hē mauagaofie, e heāheāloa koa maua. E lua a faiga māhani a Nanumea mana maua he fonu, me i te ika tenei he ika o te fenua telā e 'tau o tufa.

Te igoa ake o te Faletolu ko Te Kau o te Telagai. "Telagai," he mea fakalagalaga telā e fakaaogāgina e te kau mō te haga a lātou ki te pukega o fonu. A te telega tenei e i ai ni muna a lātou i te pukega o fonu mai moana i te faitu pili ki te fa'kai ki togālā-saute.

He tino mai te kopiti e mate hana fonu mai gataifale, a te fonu tenā e avake ke kai i te āhiga ko te mea i te pātele katoa a tino. Kae ko tautai ake kolā e hē tele mai te kau o te Telagai, kae e mate he 'lou fonu i mō mea ake, e 'lei mana kai e lātou i mō mea e loto lātou ki ai.

Taligamālō

Ko te faka agatonuga ki tino kolā e olo atu ki uta i te fenua. He faifaiga tenei e māhani ki ai a te fenua ko Nanumea. I pō mua, atu lā ko te 1901 i te taimi koa talia i ai a tino ke saina o olo o gālue i te one o Panapa mō Nauru.

E tofu katoa a tino taki tokotahi mō laulau mea'kai, kae 'pau katoa a meakai i luga i laulau: he potu fekei (me ko fakalala), moa, ika, mō meakai ake hoki, kae ko te mea inu he fuipi.

I pō nei, a te taligamālō, e tai fakapogai tonu ailoa mō tino Nanumea kolā e fai tautino sene ki te fakavae tupe a te fenua. I taimi e pule ailoa a

People say that if someone not from the Tufa group were to be so bold as to try to do the distribution, the food could be distributed incorrectly and people might not get their proper shares. Similarly, for the Nifo dividers, they are able to cut up fish in such a way that everyone can receive an equal share.

Formerly, it was clear that the distributors and the dividers had two separate roles. Today, however, the two groups seem to have combined their work.

Customs regarding Turtles

Turtles provide delectable food that everyone loves, but they are only caught once in a while. Two Nanumean customs ensured that when a turtle became available, it would be widely shared within the community.

The other name for the Faletolu kopiti is Te Kau o Telagai. Telagai ("turtle float") refers to an implement used in this group's traditional work as turtle catchers. This lineage had the prerogative of catching sea turtles in the ocean off the south-western shore of the village.

When someone from this kopiti caught a turtle within the specified boundaries near the village, he should bring it to be eaten in the āhiga, where everyone who wanted some could have a portion. When fishermen from other lineages catch a turtle elsewhere, they are free to cook and eat it themselves in the bush.

Hospitality to Guests (Taligamālō)

Nanumeans who return to the island after an absence, or other people who come as visitors, are given a special welcome. This is a Nanumean custom. Starting about 1901, people began to be hired as contract workers on the phosphate islands of Banaba and Nauru.

Each newly-returned worker would be given a large woven platter with feast delicacies, each receiving exactly the same food: a bowl of fekei or fakalala pudding, a whole chicken, fish, other foods, plus a bundle of ten drinking nuts.

Today, welcome feasts are held especially for returning Nanumeans who have contributed money to the Island Fund. However, it is ultimately the responsibility of the Council of

tino o te aganū (te Tokofitu) mō lātou e 'tau o fai he taligamālō ki ai.

Te Taligamālō a te Lotu Kelisiano

Mai te kamataga ailoa o ahi mai ki a te atu Tuvalu a te LMS e i ai he savali e fai ai te LMS mai Samoa i tauhaga takitahi. Ni kāmata o āhi ki Nanumea i te tauhaga 1866.

Mai te taimi koa mavae mai ai a tātou mai te pulepulega a te ekalesia lahi a te LMS i Samoa, fakagata atu hoki ailoa mō te taligāmālō māhani tenei. Kae e tumau ailoa a te faiga talimālō a te Ekalesia Kelisiano i Nanumea i taimi o huiakiga o faifeau a fenua.

Taligamālō Nāteaho Loa

A 'tou tupuga mua e i ai nei ni 'lou talitali e fai ki tino o fenua fakaatea e ovake ki 'tou fenua i pō mua? E, e i ai e fai. I tuhituhiga a kāpeni o te vaka velo tafolā ko Henry Pease (ni fanake ki uta i konei i te 1853), e penā hoki a te misionale A.W. Murray mō te tama akoga i mea ola ko Eduard Graeffe (ni ovake fakatahi ki uta nei i te tauhaga 1866) ni maua mai ai a mau konei.

A tino e o'mai ki uta nei e i ai he 'lou fakatāuga ia te talitali fai pona mai mua o te taliga ke olo tele lātou ki uta i te fenua. A te taligamālō tenā e fakamatalagina me e pogia a tona faiga kāmata mai te katoga ke oko ki mō mea e 'tau.

Pease (1854) ni tuhi e ia a te talitali ni fai kia te ia e fai i te katoga e fā a tao 'loa e hulu ki lalo i te one. I ona manatu me i tao konei e fakamailoga ai a feao e fā, me i tafa o tao konei e moe i ai a niu mō meakai ake.

Penei mō taligamālō o pō nei, a faifaiga o mea penei o pō mua e pelā me koa fai mō hui ai a te fenua katoa, kolā e kakau atu i ai o te taulahiga o tama lalahi. E pelā mō te mea koa maua ake nei i faigāmea penā i pō nei, te talosaga koa fai, ko te kau fakatakitaki e pogai ki ai te faiga mō meaalofoa koa mafai o tuku ki mālō.

Ko te Puke Hoa

Chiefs (Tokofitu) to decide who should be formally welcomed with a feast.

Hosting of Church Visitors

Since the beginning of LMS mission activity in Tuvalu, the mission headquarters in Samoa would send a visiting delegation to the group every year. These visits to Nanumea began in 1866.

Once the Tuvalu Christian Church became independent from the Samoa-based London Missionary Society, these annual voyages ended. However, Nanumea continues its tradition of Church welcome ceremonies every four years when the island receives a new pastor.

Greeting Guests in Ancient Times

Did our ancestors also use special rituals to welcome visitors who came ashore in Nanumea long ago? Yes, they did. The writings of whaling captain Henry Pease (who visited in 1853) as well as those by missionary A. W. Murray and naturalist Eduard Graeffe (who visited together in 1866) provide evidence about these.

Newcomers were obliged to participate in a long and complicated ritual before they were allowed to walk around on the island. These welcome ceremonies are described as taking an entire day, beginning on the beach and then moving inland as the day progressed.

Pease (1854) wrote that during the ceremony on the beach, four long spears were stuck vertically into the sand. He thought that the spears represented four main gods since some offerings of coconuts and other foods were placed beside each one.

Like welcoming taligamālō today, these ancient ceremonies seem to have been conducted on behalf of the island as a whole and involved most of its adult members. And just as we find in today's ceremonies, prayers were offered, community leaders played key roles, and gifts were presented to visitors.

Partnering (Puke Hoa)

E hē motuhia, a te puke hoa ko he vaega e tahi o te mea ko te "talimālō." I te taimi telā koa talia i ai ke olo a tino o ga'lue i te one o Panapa, ko Nanumea a te fenua ni fai tele i ai a te sainaga tenei ki Panapa.

E olo ake a tino o te fenua ki uta i te āhiga, koa fakaholo i ai a igoa o tino 'fou. Kae ko koe a te tino Nanumea, e kalaga koe penei: "E oku a te hoa tenā." Ke oko ailoa ki te taimi telā e oti i ai a tino. E mafai o tokolua me tokotolu a hoa o he tino/kāiga e tahi.

A lātou lā konei, koa fai pelā me ni kāiga 'hai o koe (i tafa o te toto) kae koa fai hoki ailoa pelā me ni tino tonu ailoa o te kāiga. Koa mafai o'noho mō koe i tou fale, ke oko ailoa ki te taimi e 'foki ai a lātou ki olotou fenua tonu.

I pō nei, pelā me koa hē ola malosi a te faifaiga tenei, me ko te tokoukega o tino e olo atu ki Nanumea, koa iloa ailoa e lātou a olotou kāiga 'hai kolā ni fai i pō mua.

The practice known as "Taking a Partner" (Puke hoa) can also be thought of as a kind of welcome ceremony. This custom developed during the time when labor recruiting for workers in the phosphate works in Banaba was at its peak.

Nanumeans would go to the āhiga and the names of workers from the other islands would be read out. If you were a Nanumean, you could call out, "That one is my partner!" This continued until all the newcomers had been chosen by a Nanumean partner. A single Nanumean family might have two or three partners.

These newcomers would be brought in the family as a "tied relative (kāiga 'hai)," a relative not related by blood, and would be treated just as though they were real members of the family. They would live with you in your house until they returned to their homes, usually on the next ship visit.

Today, this custom is fading because most of the people who come to Nanumea already have their "tied relatives" from the past.